



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

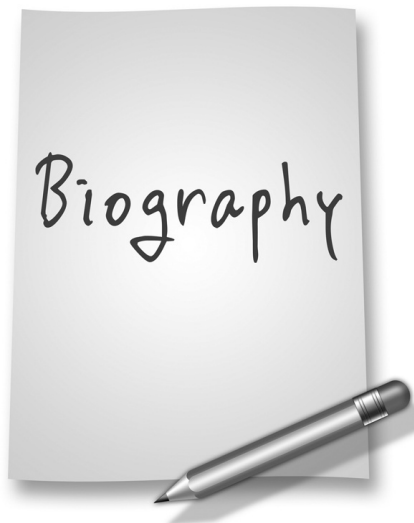
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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Courage and Conviction/The Story of Sojourner Truth.



Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons for or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Can you think of a person in your country's history who fought for the rights of others? What did they do?
- What qualities did they possess? Courage? Strength?

Can Do Statements

- I can write a biography.
- I can talk about social issues as well as moral or personal dilemmas.
- I can write about things that happened, were happening or had happened.





Let's Explore!

Sojourner Truth devoted her life to fighting for women's rights and the end of conflict.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Sojourner Truth, a self-given name, was born a slave in 1797. Her father, James Baumfree, was captured and put into slavery and her mother Mau-Mau Bet, came from a family of slaves transported from Guinea. She and her family were living on an estate, north of New York, until 1806. At 9 years old, Truth was sold at an auction along with a flock of sheep for \$100. She was sold off to a number of demanding, abusive slave owners, finally coming to live and work in West Park, New York.

It was during this period that Truth, who had only spoken Dutch before this, learned English. In 1700, the state of New York was beginning to start the negotiations that would lead to the abolition of slavery. They emancipated all slaves in 1827. Soon after, she petitioned the court to secure the release of one of her children who had been taken to the South. Her case, where a black woman was successful in challenging a white man in a US court, was groundbreaking. In 1843, Truth dropped her slave name, Isabella Baumfree. From then on, she devoted her life to the Methodist Church and to abolishing slavery. Furthermore, she joined the Northampton Association of Education and Industry, a group dedicated to the fight for rights for women and pacifism.

During the Civil War, Truth helped the Union recruit black men to be troops. On several occasions, she met with President Abraham Lincoln to discuss her beliefs and experiences. Sojourner Truth died on November 26th, 1883, and is buried beside other members of her family at Battle Creek. This determined and courageous woman spoke passionately on women's rights, prison reform, and universal suffrage for the latter part of her life.





Let's Practice!

Truth faced a number of barriers in her life.

Instructions: Read the text again. Use the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

continued / sold / flock / joined / met / challenged / beliefs
/ pacifism / white / suffrage / reform / case

1. On several occasions, she _____ with President Abraham Lincoln to discuss her _____ and experiences.
2. Truth _____ to speak passionately on women's rights, prison _____ and universal _____ till the end of her life.
3. Furthermore, she _____ the Northampton Association of Education and Industry, a group fighting for women's rights and _____.
4. At nine, Truth was _____ at auction with a _____ of sheep for \$100.
5. Her _____ was one of the first in which a black woman successfully _____ a _____ man in a United States court.



Let's Practice!

How much do you know about the people in your life?

Instructions: Choose a family member (grandparent, aunt, uncle, etc.) and write a 160-180 word biography on their life. Write the events in chronological order. Include dates and facts.

Write about things that happened, were happening or had happened in the course of their life. What events shaped or changed this person's life? Did he or she overcome obstacles? Take risks? What makes this person special or interesting? What are the adjectives you would use to describe the person? What examples from their life illustrate these qualities?





Extension Activity

Every society has their heroes.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Research a person from your country's history who fought for the rights or beliefs of others.
- Make notes on their life including dates, events, qualities, and achievements.
- Write a 180-200 word biography based on your research.
- Include different verbs to describe past events.
- Place the information in chronological order.
- When complete, read the biography aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research a person who has changed the lives of others.

☐ ☐

I write a biography of a person who helped shape my country.

☐ ☐

I write events in chronological order in a biography.

☐ ☐

I write different forms of the Past tenses.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- slavery** (noun): the practice of owning slaves
e.g. Sojourner Truth, a self-given name, was born a slave in 1797.
- abolition** (noun): the act of officially ending or stopping something
e.g. In 1700, the state of New York was beginning to start the negotiations that would lead to the abolition of slavery.
- pacifism** (noun): the belief that it is wrong to use war or violence to settle disputes
e.g. Furthermore, she joined the Northampton Association of Education and Industry, a group dedicated to the fight for rights for women and pacifism.
- troops** (noun): a group of soldiers
e.g. Truth helped the Union recruit black men to be troops.
- suffrage** (noun): the right to vote in an election
e.g. She fought for universal suffrage.
- flock** (noun): a group of birds or animals
e.g. At 9 years old, Truth was sold at an auction along with a flock of sheep for \$100.
- to emancipate** (verb): to free someone from someone else's control or power
e.g. They emancipated all slaves in 1827.
- reform** (noun): to improve someone or something by removing or correcting faults or problems
e.g. She was interested in prison reform.





Learning Points

Writing Tip: Using Narrative Tenses

You can use various tenses in your writing to relate events or tell stories.

You can write in narrative tenses when you want to tell a story or recall past events. The tenses are the Simple Past, Past Continuous and Past Perfect. You can use these tenses in the affirmative, negative and interrogative form (questions).

Remember not to mix present and past tenses when you are narrating.

	Simple Past	Past Continuous	Past Perfect
Affirmative:	<u>regular -ed endings</u> (called, walked) <u>irregular</u> (drive, drove)	<u>be (was/were) + verb- ing</u> (was driving, was running)	<u>had + past participle</u> (had eaten, had driven)
Negative:	<u>did + not + base form of verb</u> (did not/didn't drive)	<u>be + not + verb-ing</u> (wasn't driving)	<u>had + not + past participle</u> (had not/hadn't driven)
Wh-questions:	<u>wh- question word + did + subject + base form of verb + ?</u> (Who did you call?) <u>wh- question word (as subject) + past of verb + ?</u> (Who called?)	<u>wh- question word + was/were + subject + verb-ing + ?</u> (What was she driving?) <u>wh- question word (as subject) + was/were + verb-ing + ?</u> (Who was driving?)	<u>wh- question word + had + subject + past participle + ?</u> (What had he taken?) <u>wh- question word (as subject) + had + past participle + ?</u> (Who had taken the medicine?)
Yes/No questions:	<u>did + subject + past of verb + ?</u> (Did you call?)	<u>was/were + subject + verb-ing + ?</u> (Were you driving?)	<u>had + subject + past participle + ?</u> (Had he taken the pills?)
Used for:	main events of the story	details that would describe the scene or atmosphere, the background details	flashbacks or when talking about an action that happened before another past action



Learning Points

Examples:

- Sojourner Truth, a self-given name, **was** born a slave in 1797.
- She and her family **were living** on an estate, north of New York, until 1806.
- In 1700, the state of New York **was beginning** to start the negotiations that would lead to the abolition of slavery.
- During the Civil War, Truth **helped** the Union recruit black men to be troops.
- Soon after, she **petitioned** the court to secure the release of one of her children who had been taken to the South.

